

1996 to 2024

### Florida Presidential Election Trends (1996-2024)

Analyzing voting patterns across eight presidential elections in Florida, covering county-level results for major party candidates from 1996 through 2024.

**Voter Turnout Trends:**

- 1996 Baseline** - Clinton vs Dole: Both parties around 8M votes
- 2000 Surge** - Massive 140% increase in reported votes (likely data aggregation differences)
- 2008 Low Point** - Both parties saw reduced turnout (13.1M Republican, 12.6M Democrat)
- 2012-2020 Growth** - Steady increase reaching peak engagement in 2016
- 2024 Continued Engagement** - Latest election maintains high turnout levels

**Competitive Dynamics:**

- 2000 Election** - Extremely close: Gore 16.5M vs Bush 19.1M in aggregated county data
- 2012 Shift** - First election where Democrats outperformed Republicans (18.8M vs 18.1M)
- 2016 Republican Peak** - Largest Republican margin with 21.4M votes
- 2020 Tight Race** - Gap narrowed to just 1.2M votes (20.2M vs 19.0M)
- 2024 Results** - Republican margin strengthened compared to 2020

**County Patterns:**

- Top 10 counties show distinct urban vs rural voting patterns
- Miami-Dade, Broward, and Palm Beach lead in total turnout
- County-level trends mirror statewide partisan shifts through 2024

Top Candidates by Election Year

| Election Year | Candidate Name           | Party Name | Total Votes |
|---------------|--------------------------|------------|-------------|
| 1996          | Bill Clinton Al Gore     | Democrat   | 2,545,968   |
| 1996          | Bob Dole Jack Kemp       | Republican | 2,243,324   |
| 1996          | Kevin Beck               | Democrat   | 66,415      |
| 1996          | Joe Scarborough          | Republican | 175,648     |
| 1996          | Allen Boyd               | Democrat   | 138,100     |
| 1996          | Bill Sutton              | Republican | 94,030      |
| 1996          | Corrine Brown            | Democrat   | 98,047      |
| 1996          | Preston Fields           | Republican | 62,166      |
| 1996          | Karen Thurman            | Democrat   | 161,027     |
| 1996          | Dave Gentry              | Republican | 100,023     |
| 1996          | Newell O'Brien           | Democrat   | 78,886      |
| 1996          | Clifford (Cliff) Stearns | Republican | 161,464     |

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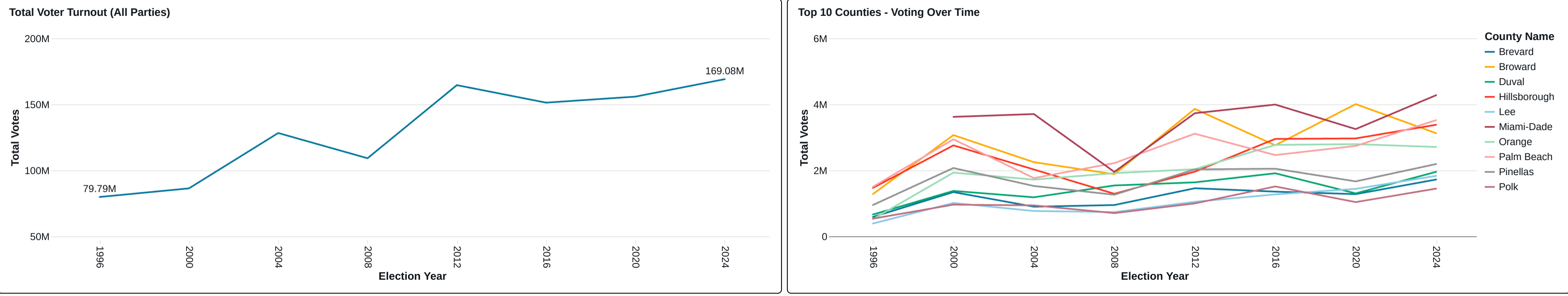
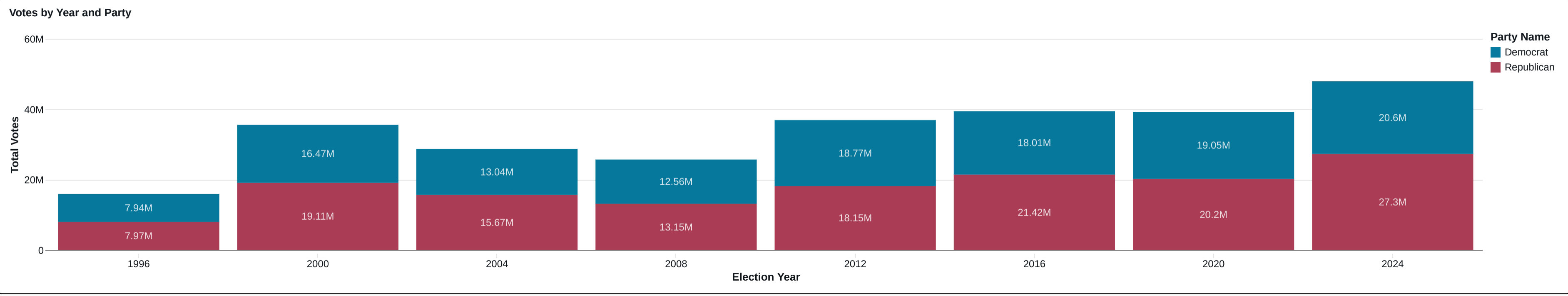
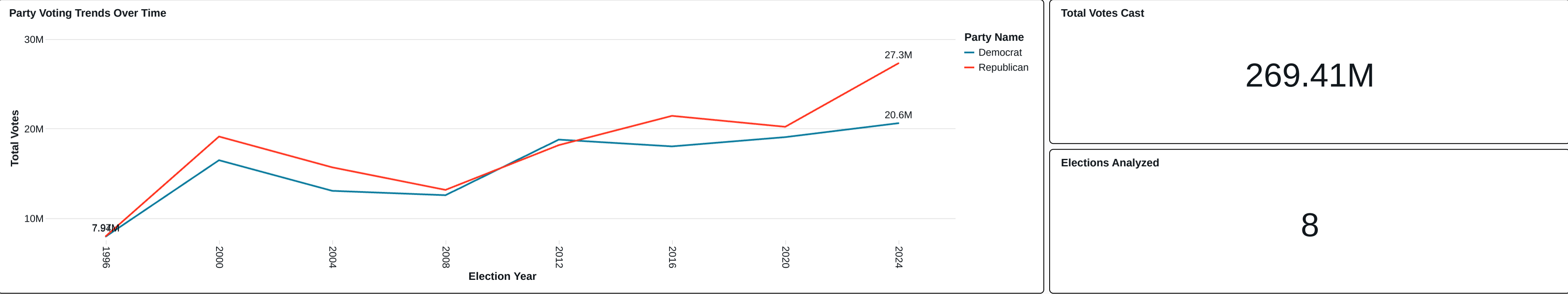
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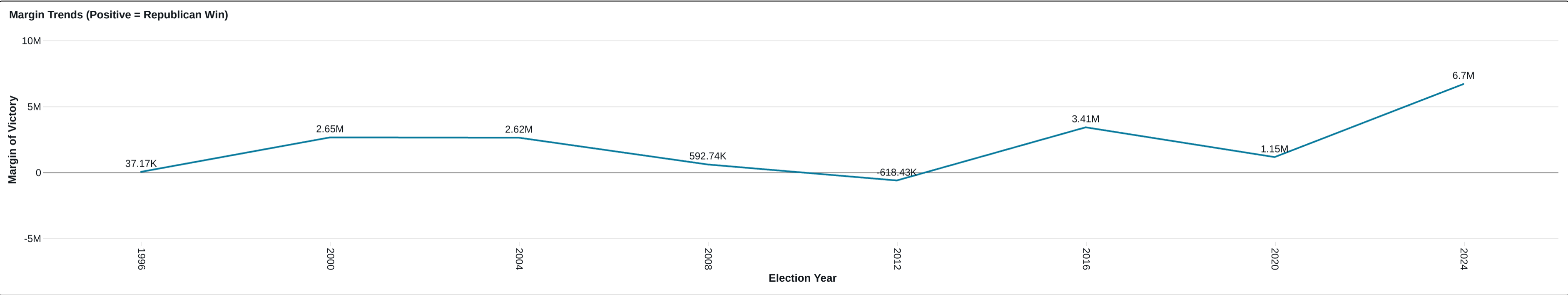
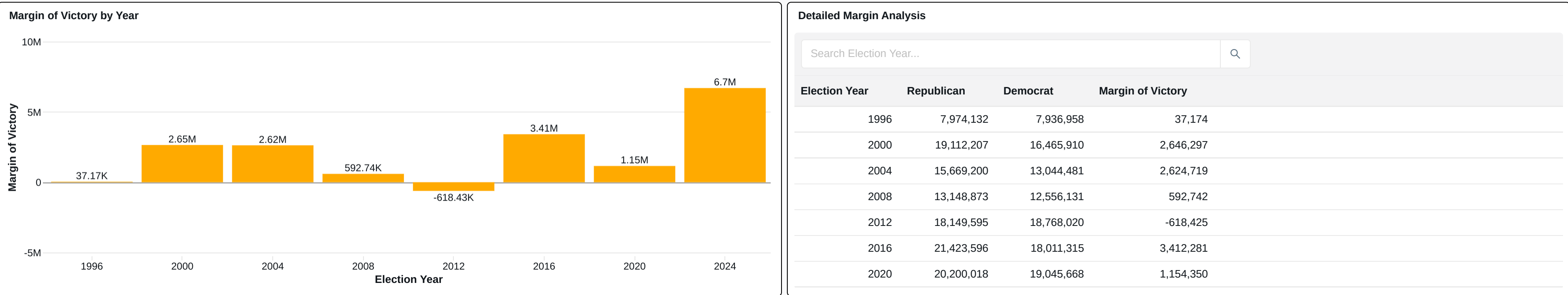
### Margin of Victory Analysis

The margin of victory measures Republican votes minus Democrat votes. Positive values = Republican win, Negative values = Democrat win.

**Key Findings:**

- 1996** - Extremely tight race: Republicans won by just 37,174 votes (0.5% margin)
- 2000-2004** - Consistent Republican advantage: ~2.6M vote margins
- 2008** - Margin tightened dramatically to 592K votes as turnout dropped
- 2012** - Only Democratic victory: -618K margin (Democrats won by 618,425 votes)
- 2016** - Largest Republican margin: +3.4M votes (Trump's strongest performance)
- 2020** - Margin narrowed to 1.15M votes, showing increased Democratic competitiveness

**Trend:** Florida shifted from narrow Republican advantages (1996-2008) to a brief Democratic win (2012), then swung heavily Republican (2016), before becoming more competitive again (2020).



### Charlotte County Analysis

Key insights in Charlotte County Florida.

- Reliably Republican with it's smallest margin among the Obama elections (2008 & 2012)

